Japan

Use an atlas and at least one other reliable source. Answer in your own words. Record the sources you use. Continue longer answers or map sketches on another sheet.

1. Find it on a map

Where is this country? Name its continent and one neighboring country or nearby island. Sketch a small locator map.

2. Find the capital

Which city is the capital, or where is the government based? If more than one city has a role, explain the difference.

3. Explore a language

Find a language used in this country. Where or by whom is it used? Explain why one language does not describe everyone who lives there.

4. Check the currency

What currency or currencies are used? Give the name, code, and date of your source. Check whether an older source gives a different answer.

Sources I used

Record the author or organization, title, URL or book page, and date checked.

South Africa

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Japan

Teaching focus: Locate two countries and compare a single capital with several capital roles. Use evidence to research languages and currencies.

Assess evidence and reasoning. These are research questions, not a fixed answer key. Adapt the task to your learners.

Reference snapshot

Continent in our dataset: Asia

Capitals and government seats: Tokyo (Capital)

Languages in our dataset: Japanese

Currencies in our dataset: Japanese yen (JPY)

Reference reviewed 2026-10-14. Community dataset fields are not a complete account of language use or an independent audit of every fact. Check current official sources for changing details.

What to look for

1. Find it on a map: Accept well-supported continent conventions. Island countries may have no land neighbors; a nearby island or country is a valid answer.

2. Find the capital: Use the reference facts as a starting point. Accept multiple capitals or government seats when their roles are correctly explained; some countries have no official capital.

3. Explore a language: The reference lists languages from the dataset and is not a complete account of language use. Learners should support a specific example and avoid treating a country as culturally uniform.

4. Check the currency: Check current official sources when possible. Currency arrangements can change and may include more than one currency. The reference is a dated snapshot.

Sources and further reading

Pinned mledoze/countries community database

https://github.com/mledoze/countries/blob/c2ac0049c14edcf2436c7aa1b2493222a020b462/countries.json

Study in Japan: Tokyo

https://www.studyinjapan.go.jp/en/why/47prefectures/kanto/tokyo.html

Database attribution: mledoze/countries and contributors, adapted by GlobePick. ODbL 1.0: https://opendatacommons.org/licenses/odbl/1-0/ . Questions and teaching notes may be copied and adapted for classroom use.

South Africa

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Reference snapshot

Continent in our dataset: Africa

Capitals and government seats: Pretoria (Administrative capital); Cape Town (Legislative capital); Bloemfontein (Judicial capital)

Languages in our dataset: Afrikaans, English, Southern Ndebele, Northern Sotho, Southern Sotho, Swazi, Tswana, Tsonga, Venda, Xhosa, Zulu

Currencies in our dataset: South African rand (ZAR)

Bloemfontein: Home to the Supreme Court of Appeal. The Constitutional Court is in Johannesburg.

Reference reviewed 2026-10-14. Community dataset fields are not a complete account of language use or an independent audit of every fact. Check current official sources for changing details.

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South African government: provinces and capitals

https://www.gov.za/about-sa/south-africas-provinces

Department of Justice: courts and their roles

https://www.justice.gov.za/about/sa-courts.html

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